



Figure 1: Welcome screen of OpenOffice.org

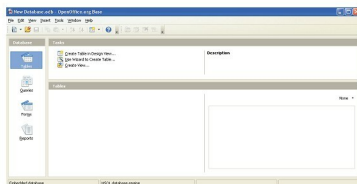


Figure 2: Database window

database, since image fields consume too much memory, and tend to slow down the system. Therefore, the field named photo will store the path and file name of the photo image file. The path is not required if the photo is stored in the same directory as the database. In this case, I have stored the image files (PNG and JPG files) in a directory named base.

The field named *empid* is meant to have a unique number that will uniquely identify the record, and so will require some modification. First, in order to define this field as the *primary key*, right-click on the field and select *Primary Key* from the pop-up menu. Next, from the options at the bottom of the window, choose *Auto increment*, so that each record will have a unique number. Finally, your table structure will look like what's shown in Figure 3. Save the table, naming it '*empdetail*'. If you click the *Tables* icon and then '*personal*' table, you will get a window like the one shown in Figure 4. You can enter data directly into the table in this data view, but this is not user-friendly or convenient. Instead, let's create a form for data entry.

Creating a form

Click the *Forms* icon in the database window, and then click *Use Wizard to Create Form*. This will start the form wizard, as shown in Figure 5. The wizard has eight steps, as you can see in the left pane of the window in Figure 5, including *Field Selection*, *Set up sub form*, and ending with *Set name*.

First, select the *empdetail* table in the combo box; its fields will be listed in the *Available Fields* list box. Click the >> icon to add all the fields to the form, and click *Next*. When asked if you want to include a sub-form, ignore it and click *Next*. You will be presented with another screen, offering you a choice of how to arrange the controls. I have selected

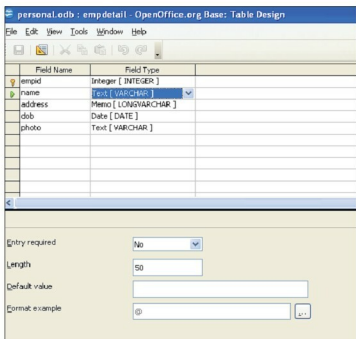


Figure 3: Structure of table 'empdetail'

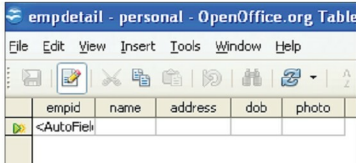


Figure 4: 'empdetail' table with no records

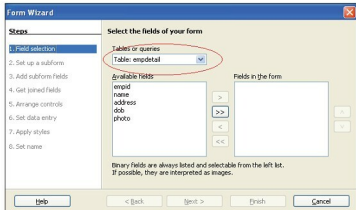


Figure 5: Form wizard window

the second one. Click *Next* through the rest of the steps, and finally you will get a form as shown in Figure 6. You can rearrange the fields by dragging and dropping, if you wish. I will keep the design as it is, except for the *dob* field, for which we will use a more sophisticated entry method.

First, close the form, saving it with the name *empdetail*. Right-click the form and choose *Edit*, and it will be opened in design mode (Figure 7). Look at the tool box toolbar at the left side of the window (in a red ellipse in the figure). It provides different widgets that you can draw on the form.